

Illustration by TANMOY CHAKRABORTY



"Organisations and government agencies involved in creating digital public infrastructure have been building micro-services architecture, the kind used by Meta or Google, at a minimal cost. Once built, government and private sectors can come together to deliver e-governance to a huge population"

– VIJAY TYAGI
Founder, eGov Foundation

And now, evolving technologies such as cloud computing, big data analytics and blockchain are being used as OSS in the e-governance space. OSS-based next-gen technologies enabled the government to rapidly build change, enhance and deploy digital services, as was seen when the Covid pandemic reached the country's shores. India was one of the few countries that could deliver vaccination certificates at the click of a mouse.

WHAT INDIA NEEDS TO MASTER

While the adoption of OSS enhances interoperability with other e-governance solutions, this hasn't happened on a larger scale. There is a need to connect various e-governance applications provided by central agencies and state governments, particularly in the same sector, to further streamline and improve quality of services and avoid duplication.

The government must also encourage civic agencies to go for OSS collaborations with private players. India already has in place a policy for OSS adoption. The Centre has made it mandatory for all central agencies to consider OSS along with proprietary products while creating any new digital service. This policy should be made compulsorily applicable for states as well. ■

JANAAGRAHA

The Bengaluru-based non-profit works in the areas of civic participation, municipal finance and policy and insights. Among its initiatives is the MyCityMyBudget initiative. It also runs the Swachhata mobile application for the government's Swachh Bharat Mission

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No. of Mission Mode Projects under the government's National eGovernment Plan